

Old Business

for

Piano, Bass, Drum Set,
and Narrator

Based on poetry by

Charles Simic

(*from Dismantling the Silence,
IV: Bestiary for the Fingers of My Right Hand**)

*poem used by permission of the author

Music by Christopher Kies

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1.

♩ = 76

Narrator: "Thumb,....
At the time of my birth.

kick-bass

Narr.: Cut him off. He....
....hunting with wolves.

2.

"Tango" $\text{♩} = 66$

Drum Set

2 Bongos
2 Congas

mp *f* *mp*

T. (tone) B. (bass)

Piano

close keyboard cover,
and play "piano percussion"

Bass

pizz. *gliss.*

Narrator

N.B.: In this movement, the narrator may choose to imitate somewhat the style of speech-song that one would hear in a Kurt Weill opera.

left hand, knuckles on keyboard cover
right hand, flat 2nd finger, on keyboard cover

The se-cond

Piano Perc.

mf *m.d. 2* *m.s. sopra* *m.s. sotto* *m.s. knuckles* *mp*

flat of left hand, fingers 2-5, under key bed
flat of left hand, fingers 2-5, on keyboard cover

4

D.S.

T.

p

3

Cb.

4

mp

Nar.

points the way. True way. The path cros-ses the earth,

Pno. Perc.

p

♩ = 80 "Third Finger Blues"

Piano } (only to be played only
with the third
finger of the right hand)

Pno.

(drums vamp with bass
for four bars)

pizz.

 mf

4.

Drum Set $\text{♩} = 54$ take medium soft/wrapped mallets

Piano (piano part: c flat, b flat, and c: depress silently and catch sostenuto pedal with left foot; also, with left foot, engage soft pedal)
(use right hand: 4th finger) *pp* (use pedal to make legato)

Bass *pizz.* *mf* *sosten. ped. to bar 4, beat 2* *arco* *sempre tenuto* *pp*

D.S. *pp* *m.d.: 4th finger* *pp* *release sostenuto pedal* *take wooden drum stricks* **Narrator:**
The fourth is mystery.

Pno. *pp* *m.s.* *m.d.: 4th finger* *mp* *mp* *m.d.: 4th finger* *p*

Cb. *pp*

5 *H.H. closed* *p* *crash* *mp* *He jumps by himself* *p*

Pno. *pp*

Cb. *bass harmonics sound at written octave* *flautando* *pp*

5.

$\text{♩} = 69$
take drum sticks

bars 3-5, improv. with bass, ending with cymbal on bar 5 down beat. etc.

Drum Set

Piano

Bass

lirico

mp

arco

5 5 5 etc.

f

f

free two bar improv. with drums

C7

5

$\text{♩} = 88-92$ comp the bass, slow swing, bars 8-27

ride

choke final 8th

D.S.

mp

p

8va straight eighths

p

Narrator(start on beat three):
Something stirs in the fifth
Of birth. Weak and submissive,
His touch is gentle.
It weighs a tear.
It takes the mote out of the eye.

Pno.

mp

pizz.

mp

10

D.S.

Pno.

Cb.

mp

mp

mp